

IIT TABLE FOOTBALL TOURNAMENT RULES - TRADITIONAL STYLE

1. Tournament Format

Single round-robin league (every team plays against every other team in a single match). At the end of the league stage, the top 8 teams will qualify for the knockout final stage (Quarter-Finals, Semi-Finals, 3rd Place Match, and Final), according to the following bracket:

Stage	Match	Teams
Quarter-Finals	QF1	1st Seed vs 8th Seed
Quarter-Finals	QF2	4th Seed vs 5th Seed
Quarter-Finals	QF3	2nd Seed vs 7th Seed
Quarter-Finals	QF4	3rd Seed vs 6th Seed
Semi-Finals	SF1	Winner QF1 vs Winner QF2
Semi-Finals	SF2	Winner QF3 vs Winner QF4
3rd/4th Place Final	3PM	Loser SF1 vs Loser SF2
1st/2nd Place Final	FIN	Winner SF1 vs Winner SF2

2. Match Organization

Once the schedule is published, each team will independently arrange their matches by contacting their opponents. The deadline to complete the group stage will be communicated after registration closes.

Location: Table located in the CCT Morego cafeteria.

Access hours: From 8:00 AM to 3:00 PM (cafeteria closes at 3:30 PM).

Make-up round: A dedicated make-up round will be scheduled for any matches not played during the main season, with dates communicated after registration closes. If a match is still not played within this period, both teams will receive a forfeit loss (0-10, 0 points in the standings).

3. Scoring and Standings

- **Group Stage:**
 - **Win (3 points):** Awarded to the team that reaches **10 goals** first.
 - **Draw (1 point each):** If the score reaches **9-9**, the match ends immediately in a draw.
 - **Tie-breaking criteria:** In case of a tie in points between two or more teams at the end of the group stage, the ranking will be determined by **goal difference** (goals scored minus goals conceded). In case of a further tie, head-to-head result and finally total goals scored will be considered.
- **Knockout Stage (Quarter-Finals, Semi-Finals, and Finals):**
- **Advantage Rule (No Draws):** At **9-9**, the match continues under the advantage rule: to win, a team must lead by **2 goals** (e.g., 11-9, 12-10, 13-11, etc.). Draws are not allowed in the knockout stage.

4. Reporting Results

After each match, the final score must be sent via email to filippo.drago@iit.it , simone.nitti@iit.it , and calogero.boscarini@iit.it with the mandatory subject line: **Table football tournament**.

Submission rule: The sender must **CC all other players** who participated in the match and clearly specify both team names and the final score in the email body.

5. Service and Ball Placement

The first service of the match is determined by coin toss/draw.

Subsequent services belong to the team that has just conceded a goal.

The ball may be put into play from the center of the table or inserted through the central hole without imparting any spin.

Before a direct goal can be scored from the service, the ball must touch at least one table side-wall and one midfield player figure.

6. Fouls and Infractions

If a goal results from an action affected by a foul, the point is **annulled** and play resumes from the defense of the player who suffered the infraction. The following are considered fouls:

Spinning (Rullare): Rotating the rod more than 360° before or after hitting the ball.

Passing/Carom (Gancio): Passing the ball between figures on the same rod or double touching with the same figure; caroming the ball in a single shot off two figures on the same rod (unintentional hook).

Dragging (Trascinamento): Dragging the ball with the player figure before shooting or passing.

Aerial Shots / Lobs (Pallonetto): Raising the ball into the air over one or more rods.

Jars and Vibrations: Banging or slamming the rods against the side-walls to disturb the opponent or moving the table to affect the ball's trajectory.

Interference / Hand Contact: It is strictly forbidden to touch the ball with hands, blow on it, or influence its movement with any body part or external object while in play. Hand contact is allowed **only when the ball is completely stopped** (e.g., dead ball) or before serving.

7. Dead Ball, Out of Bounds, and Position Swaps

- **Dead ball:** If the ball stops out of reach of any figure:
 - If in the midfield area, it is served again from the center:
 - *CASE 1 (During service):* The team that initially served re-serves the ball.
 - *CASE 2 (During play):* The ball is served by the team with fewer points; in case of a tie, the decision is at the teams' discretion.
 - If in the defensive zone, the ball is given to that side's goalkeeper/defense.
- **Out of bounds:** If the ball pops out of the table, play resumes from the defense of the team that was defending at the time of the action.
- **Position swaps:** Role swaps between attacker and defender may only take place when play is stopped.